

Cafe SCM

User Guide for Cart Workers and the Owner

What this app does: you tap what you sold on your phone. The app works out which ingredients each sale used, takes them out of your cart's stock, and shows the owner live sales, stock, shortages, wastage and costs for every location.

Main rule: you record *what happened* (sold, received, wasted, sent), and the app works out *how much stock* there is. You never type in "we have 17 buns left".

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Locations: Central Storage, Cart 1, Cart 2, Cart 3 · Currency: ₹ INR · Time zone: IST
Version: September 2026

1. What the app tracks

Every record keeps **who** did it, **when**, **where** (which cart or Central Storage), and **why**. Nothing is ever deleted. A mistake is fixed with a correction that shows up next to the original.

What is tracked	Details recorded	Recorded by
Sales (orders)	Products and quantities, price at the time of sale, order total, time, cart, worker. Ingredients used are worked out from the recipe automatically.	Worker (Sell tab)
Ingredient use	For each sale: recipe × quantity. <i>Example: 3 Burgers = 3 buns, 3 patties, 60 g mayonnaise.</i>	Automatic
Purchases / receipts	Material, quantity (kg / g / l / ml / pcs), price paid, supplier, bill number. Updates the average cost of the material.	Worker (Receive tab) or owner
Wastage	Material, quantity, reason (Dropped, Spoiled, Damaged, Expired, Prep waste, Other), cost of the loss.	Worker (Waste tab)
Transfers	Stock sent between locations: what was sent, what actually arrived (short deliveries are recorded), sent / received / cancelled.	Owner or worker; the receiving cart confirms
Stock requests	What a cart asked for, and whether it was sent, bought locally or rejected (with a reason).	Worker asks, owner decides
Stock counts	Physical count vs what the app expected. The difference is called <i>inventory variance</i> . The owner approves before stock changes.	Worker counts, owner approves
Stock levels	Live balance of every material at every location, its value in ₹, and a status (OK / Low / Critical).	Automatic
Days of stock left	Average daily use over the last 7 days, and how many days the current stock will last.	Automatic
Costs and margins	Weighted average cost per material, cost of each product, estimated gross margin (before rent, salaries and other expenses).	Automatic
VOIDS and corrections	Voided orders (with reason, ingredients go back to stock) and manual adjustments (with a required note).	Owner only
Audit log	Every change to products, recipes, prices, materials, suppliers, users and settings: who, when, old value, new value.	Automatic

What the owner can see from this

Dashboard: what needs attention first (critical stock, requests waiting, counts to approve, deliveries not received), then today's orders, sales, ingredient cost, purchases and wastage compared with the previous period. One card per cart. Updates live.

Analytics: sales and wastage trends, busy hours, best-selling products, ingredient use vs sales, what to buy, supplier price history, and cost and margin per product.

2. How long each task takes

These are **estimates** for a worker who has used the app for a few days. The first week will be slower. Times depend on how many items are on the list.

Cart worker

Task	How often	Time per task	Time per day (typical)
Sell: record an order	Every order	3 – 5 sec	8 – 12 min (≈150 orders)
Receive stock bought from a shop	1 – 3 times a day	30 – 60 sec	1 – 3 min
Record wastage	0 – 3 times a day	15 – 20 sec	under 1 min
Confirm a delivery from Central (all arrived)	When a delivery comes	5 sec	under 1 min
Confirm a delivery with something missing	Rarely	30 sec	—
Request stock	Once a day	30 – 60 sec	1 min
Send stock to another location	Rarely	30 – 60 sec	—
Count stock	Weekly, or when asked	5 – 15 min	—
Sign in	Once (stays signed in)	15 sec	—
Extra time a worker spends on the app per day			≈ 12 – 18 min

Most of this is order taps, which replace writing orders on paper. Sales are recorded while the customer is being served.

Owner

Task	How often	Time
Check the dashboard (alerts, today's sales)	2 – 3 times a day	2 min each
Handle stock requests (send from Central, bought locally, or reject)	Daily	1 – 2 min per request
Approve or reject a stock count	Weekly	2 – 5 min per count
Void a wrong order	When needed	30 sec
Check analytics / what to buy	Weekly	10 – 15 min
Export reports to Excel	Weekly / monthly	1 min
Typical total	—	≈ 10 – 15 min a day + 30 min a week

One-time setup (owner)

Task	Time
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Import menu, prices and recipes from Excel	15 – 30 min (mostly filling the sheet)
Add workers (name, username, cart, 6-digit PIN)	1 min per worker
Set reorder levels, lead times and suppliers for materials	20 – 40 min
Enter opening stock at each location	10 – 15 min per location
Each worker: install on phone and open every tab once	5 min per phone
Total	≈ 2 – 3 hours

3. Getting started

Install the app on your phone

≈ 2 min, once

- 1 Open the link the owner gives you in **Chrome** (Android) or **Safari** (iPhone).
- 2 Android: tap the : menu → **Add to Home screen**. iPhone: tap **Share** → **Add to Home Screen**.
- 3 Open the app from the new icon on your home screen. It now opens like a normal app.

No app store is needed.

Sign in

≈ 15 sec

- 1 Type your **username** (small letters, the owner gives it to you).
- 2 Type your **6-digit PIN**.
- 3 Tap **Sign in**. Workers go to the **Sell** screen. The owner goes to the **Dashboard**.

You stay signed in. The owner signs in with their email and password.

First time only: open every tab while online

≈ 1 min

Tap **Sell**, **Receive**, **Waste**, **Stock** and **More** once while you have internet. The phone then keeps a copy of the menu and materials, so the app still opens when there is no signal.

The worker screen

The tabs are at the bottom of the screen, where your thumb can reach them:

Tab	Use it to
Sell	Record what customers bought
Receive	Add stock you bought from a shop or supplier
Waste	Record anything thrown away, dropped or spoiled
Stock	See your cart's stock and confirm deliveries from Central Storage
More	Today's activity, items waiting to sync, request stock, send stock, count stock, sign out

You only see and change **your own cart**. You cannot change stock numbers directly. Stock always comes from what you record.

4. Cart worker: step by step

A. Record a sale

3 – 5 sec

Tab: Sell

- 1 Tap a product tile once for each item sold. *Burger twice = 2 Burgers.*
- 2 Tap – on a product to remove one, or **Clear** to start again.
- 3 Check the total (₹) at the bottom.
- 4 Tap **Submit order**.
- 5 Green **Order saved** = done. Amber **Saved on this phone · will sync** = no signal, but it is safe (see section 5).

The ingredients are taken out of your cart's stock automatically. There is no "are you sure?" box, so the line keeps moving.

B. Receive stock you bought

30 – 60 sec

Tab: Receive

- 1 Pick the material (for example, Burger Bun).
- 2 Enter the quantity and pick the unit (kg, g, l, ml, pcs, or a pack).
- 3 Enter the price paid if you know it. This keeps cost figures correct.
- 4 Add more lines if you bought more than one thing.
- 5 Optional: tap **Add supplier / bill details** to add the supplier, bill number and a note.
- 6 Tap **Confirm receipt**.

C. Record wastage

15 – 20 sec

Tab: Waste

- 1 Pick the material and enter how much was lost.
- 2 Tap a reason: **Dropped, Spoiled, Damaged, Expired, Prep waste** or **Other**.
- 3 Add a note if needed, then tap **Record wastage**.

Record wastage as soon as it happens. If you don't, the stock count will show a difference later that nobody can explain.

D. Confirm a delivery from Central Storage

5 – 30 sec

Tab: Stock → deliveries on the way

- 1 When the delivery arrives, check the items against the list on screen.
- 2 If everything arrived: tap **Received all**.
- 3 If something is short: tap **Something missing?**, type what *actually* arrived (leave blank if it all arrived), then tap **Confirm received**.

The stock is added to your cart only when you confirm. While it is on the way, it is not counted anywhere.

E. Request stock from the owner

30 – 60 sec

More → Request stock

- 1 Add each material you need and the quantity.
- 2 Tap **Send request**.
- 3 You can see its status on the same screen: waiting, sent, bought locally, or rejected (with a reason). You can cancel it while it is still waiting.
- 4 If the owner sends it from Central Storage, confirm it on the **Stock** tab when it arrives (step D).

F. Send stock to another location

30 – 60 sec

More → Send stock to another location

- 1 Pick where it is going (Central Storage or another cart).
- 2 Add each material and quantity.
- 3 Tap **Send stock**. It leaves your stock now. The other location adds it when they confirm.

G. Count stock

5 – 15 min

More → Count stock (or Stock tab)

- 1 Physically count each material at your cart.
- 2 Enter what you counted. The app does **not** show the expected number, so count honestly.
- 3 Add a note if needed, then tap **Submit count**.
- 4 The owner reviews it. Stock only changes after the owner approves.

Any difference is called "inventory variance". The app does not say who caused it or why.

H. Check today's activity

10 sec

More → Today's activity

Shows everything recorded at your cart today: orders, receipts, wastage and transfers.

I. Sign out

5 sec

More → Sign out

If anything is still waiting to sync, the app warns you first. **Do not sign out while items are waiting.** Connect to the internet first.

5. Working without internet

Sales, receipts and wastage work with no signal. They are saved on the phone first and sent automatically when the connection comes back (also every 30 seconds, and when the app is opened).

What you see	What it means / what to do
Order saved	The server has it. Nothing to do.
Saved on this phone · will sync	Safe on your phone. It will be sent later on its own.
Top bar: OFFLINE — 3 PENDING SYNC	No connection. 3 items are waiting. Keep working as normal.
Top bar: SYNCING 2...	Sending now.
Top bar: ⚠ 1 FAILED	The server refused an item (for example, a product was removed). Tap the bar, then Try again or Remove , and tell the owner.

No double counting: if the same order is sent twice because the signal dropped, the app records it only once.

Sync within 3 days. Records older than 72 hours are not accepted. Don't clear the browser data or uninstall the app while items are waiting.

These need internet: requesting stock, sending stock, confirming deliveries, stock counts, and all owner screens.

6. Owner: first-time setup

The owner menu has three groups: **Overview** (Dashboard, Inventory, Analytics, Reports), **Operations** (Orders, Requests, Transfers, Purchases, Wastage, Counts) and **Setup** (Products & recipes, Import, Raw materials, Suppliers, Users, Settings).

Step 1. Import menu and recipes from Excel

15 – 30 min

Setup → Import from Excel

- 1 Make a sheet with one row per product and one column per ingredient. Add a **Price** column.
- 2 Put quantities in the cells: plain numbers are pieces; use **g / kg** and **ml / l** for weight and volume (e.g. *20gm*, *200ml*).
- 3 Upload the file (.xlsx, .xls or .csv). Check the preview: new materials, new products, recipe changes and price changes.
- 4 Fix any rows listed as problems, then confirm. Either everything is saved or nothing is.

Product	Price	Burger Bun	Mayonnaise	Milk
Burger	120	1	20gm	
Shake	110			200ml

Tip: **Reports** → **Recipes** exports the current menu in this same format. Edit it in Excel and import it again.

Step 2. Add workers

1 min each

Setup → Users → Add worker

Enter the name, a username, their cart, and a 6-digit PIN. You can reset a PIN or deactivate a worker here later. A deactivated worker can't sign in.

Step 3. Set up raw materials and suppliers

20 – 40 min

Setup → Raw materials / Suppliers

For each material, set the **reorder level**, **minimum level**, **lead time** (days the supplier takes) and the default supplier. These drive the Low / Critical alerts and the "what to buy" list.

Step 4. Enter opening stock

10 – 15 min per location

Operations → Counts, or Inventory → material → Adjust stock

Do a stock count at each location (or adjust each material) so the app starts from real numbers.

Step 5. Test before going live

5 min

On a worker phone, turn on airplane mode, sell one item (you should see amber "Saved on this phone"), then turn airplane mode off. Check that the order appears **once** under **Operations** → **Orders**, then void it.

7. Owner: daily and weekly work

Check the dashboard

2 min, 2 – 3 times a day

- 1 Look at **Needs attention** first: critical stock, requests waiting, counts to approve, deliveries not received.
- 2 Check today's orders, sales, ingredient cost, purchases and wastage against the previous period.
- 3 Look at the card for each cart. The page updates on its own.

Handle stock requests

1 – 2 min each

Operations → Requests

For each request, pick one:

- **Send from Central Storage** : creates a delivery. The cart confirms it when it arrives.
- **Mark done (bought locally)** : marks it done (the cart records the purchase on Receive).
- **Reject** : give a reason. The worker sees it.

Approve stock counts

2 – 5 min each

Operations → Counts

You see counted vs expected for each material. **Approve & correct stock** to correct it, or **Reject** (with a reason) to change nothing. Sales made after the count are handled correctly, so nothing is corrected twice.

Fix mistakes

30 sec

- **Wrong order:** Operations → Orders → **Void this order** , and give a reason. The ingredients go back to stock.
- **Wrong stock:** Inventory → material → Adjust stock, with a required note.
- **Delivery sent by mistake:** Operations → Transfers → **Cancel & return stock** (only while it is on the way).

Every correction stays in the history, next to the original.

Weekly review and reports

10 – 15 min

Analytics: what to buy, wastage trends, ingredient use vs sales (large differences need a stock count), supplier prices, and margin per product.

Reports & export (Excel or CSV): Sales, Inventory, Stock movements, Purchases, Wastage, Ingredient consumption, Recipes.

Edit products, recipes and prices

1 – 3 min

Setup → Products & recipes

Editing a recipe saves a new version. Past sales keep the recipe they were made with, so old reports don't change.

8. Status colours and troubleshooting

Stock status

Status	Meaning
Critical	Below zero, at or below the minimum level, or will run out before a new order can arrive (supplier lead time).
Low	At or below the reorder level, or will run out within lead time + 2 days.
OK	Enough stock.
No data yet	Less than 3 days of history and no levels set.

Days left = current stock ÷ average daily use (sales + wastage over the last 7 days).

Suggested order = the amount needed to cover the lead time plus 7 days, minus current stock.

Common problems

Problem	What to do
"Wrong username or PIN"	Username is in small letters. Ask the owner to reset the PIN under Users. A deactivated worker can't sign in.
Top bar shows PENDING SYNC for a long time	No connection. Items are safe and will send when the phone reconnects. Sync within 3 days.
Top bar shows ⚠ FAILED	Tap it → Try again or Remove . Tell the owner (a product may have been removed).
Stock shows below zero	Sales were recorded before a purchase was entered. Record the missing receipt, or do a stock count.
A product is missing on Sell	The owner has deactivated it, or it wasn't imported. Ask the owner.
Excel import is blocked	Fix the rows listed in the preview (row numbers are shown), then upload again.
App won't open without signal	Open every tab once while online (section 3), then try again.

Good habits

- Record every sale when it happens. Don't batch them up at the end of the day.
- Record purchases and wastage straight away, with the price where known.
- Confirm deliveries only after checking what actually arrived.
- Count stock once a week, so any difference is found early.